

MGT482 - Brand Management

EVENING MBA PROGRAM

SUMMER 2026

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OFFICE HOURS: TBD on Discord or by appointment

2026 Evening Schedule

Module	FE Date	Topic(s)	Reading(s)*
1	6/29	What is a Brand?	Perspectives on Brand Equity <i>Basic Facts: Trademarks Patents and Copyrights</i> Patagonia Is Suing Pattie Gonia for Trademark Infringement
2	7/6	Brand Equity and Architecture	Why You Aren't Buying Venezuelan Chocolate How Trader Joe's Tote Bag Nation Rebranding in Turkey Brand Portfolio Strategy Case: Amul Dairy
3	7/13	Brand Components and Component Branding	Why Text-to-Image AI Requires a New Branding Mindset They're Famous, They're Everywhere, and They're Fake 3 Questions to Ask about Your Brand Case: Inside Intel Inside
4	7/20	Brand Extensions Lifestyle Brands	Extend Profits, Not Product Lines Case: Trouble Brews at Starbucks
5	7/27	Brand Life Cycle: Extending and Revitalizing the Brand	Break Free of the Product Life Cycle But is it Good? Case: Does Mattel's Iconic Barbie Doll Need a Makeover? (Case not to prepare: Dove)
6	8/3	Brand Story	Brand Storytelling <i>The Vodka Proof</i> Case: Tito's Handmade Vodka – The Perils of Success Case: Brand Storytelling at Shinola
7	8/10	Leveraging that Equity – Brand Licensing	Think Differently About Protecting Your Brand Three Trends Shaping the Future of Brand Licensing Case: Navigating a Sea of Golf Sponsorships Case: Off-White
8	8/17	Brands in Crisis	Lessons learned from Bud Light one year later The rise of brand boycotts & examples to learn from Why do so many legacy brands implode when trying to attract new customers?
9	8/24	Luxury Branding	Luxury Branding and the Creator Economy The Fundamentals of Luxury Branding Luxury Marketing: A Deep Dive into High-End Branding The Rise of Luxury Brands of Everything Case: Off-White
10	8/31	Final Exam	Final Exam

* Readings in *italics* are videos or podcasts.

Deliverables	Points
Quizzes (I) – 8 @ 6 points	48
Assignments/participation (C) - 8 @ 2 points	16
Final Exam	30
SET + other EC	6
Total	100

GRADING

Grading is done on the following scale: A [95,100]; A- [90,95); B+ [87,90); B [83,87); B- [80,83); C+ [77,80); C [73,77); C- [70,73); F [0,70)

DESCRIPTION

A brand is often a company's most important asset and as such has received immense attention in recent years. Effective brand-building and brand management drives superior financial results, consumer loyalty and competitive advantage. This is a course with a decided point-of-view on the nature of brands and the skills and tasks this requires of managers. We will consider brands as co-creations of consumers and marketers. If brand management is a collaborative process of meaning management, the job of the brand manager then becomes one of navigating the meaning making processes, attaining meanings that resonate therein, and to managing these meanings deftly through time so as to maximize brand value, capture opportunities, and diminish risk. Some of a firm's most valuable assets are the brands that it has invested in and developed over time. Although manufacturing processes can often be duplicated, strongly held beliefs and attitudes established in consumers' minds cannot.

This is a case-based course. Cases, as microcosms of brand management, deliver the power of real-world, applied settings and reveal concepts and frameworks that can inform management thoughts and actions. Our collective experience and expertise outweighs and overshadows the knowledge any one faculty member can impart. Case discussions, and the full participation they require, is an integral component of this course.

OBJECTIVES

At the close of Topics in Marketing: Brand Management you will be able to:

- Understand what makes a strong brand.
- Identify and develop the key elements in crafting a brand strategy.
- Analyze scenarios to gain insights into how to manage your brand and expand your business.
- Understand and integrate social media's role in modern branding strategy.

MATERIALS

Required

- Case and Reading Packet.

Recommended

- Kevin Lane Keller (2013), Strategic Brand Management (3rd or 4th edition). NJ: Prentice Hall. ISBN 978-0-13-2664257

ASSIGNMENTS & DELIVERABLES

Quizzes

Each week will begin with a quiz to test whether you understood the readings for the week. These are also important because we will not cover everything in the reading in class unless there are either issues with the concept or if the class finds that area particularly worth exploring. We will often use the quizzes as the jumping-off point for the evening's discussion. Because of this, quizzes will usually be at the beginning of class. **Missed quizzes may be made up the following week before class.** If you need to make up a quiz for a missed class, please show up 15 minutes before the scheduled class time.

Exercises/Participation

Class participation is earned by "attending" class by contributing your thoughts and questions to the various discussions and exercises in class. In practice, great ideas that are not articulated (or are not articulated in a compelling way) are ignored. Thus, participation is important to your continued professional development. Further, much of the value of an MBA comes from the interchange with classmates who come from various industries and strategic contexts. The benefits that each of you receive from this class will be directly enhanced by the mutual sharing of insights. Thus, throughout the term, I will track the degree to which you contribute to discussion. Please know that quality of contribution (meaningful insights that help us progress in our discussion of the topic) far outweighs quantity. **Missed exercises/participation cannot be made up except in extreme circumstances.**

Final Exam

The final exam will consist of two parts. The first part will be individual. It will primarily measure the knowledge acquisition throughout the quarter. The second part will be groups. It will primarily measure knowledge application and consist of group analysis of small cases.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind.

The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at:

<http://senate.ucsd.edu/manual/appendices/appendix2.pdf>

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or fosorio@ucsd.edu.

AI POLICY FOR MARKETING MANAGEMENT COURSE (written with the help of ChatGPT)

This policy outlines the appropriate use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools in the Marketing Management course, ensuring that the technology enhances learning while preserving the integrity of individual thought and effort. The policy applies to all enrolled students in the Executive MBA Marketing Management course.

Permitted Use of AI:

- Understanding and Research: Students are permitted to use AI tools to deepen their understanding of course materials and assist with research related to course topics. AI can be utilized to summarize readings, provide explanations of complex concepts, and generate ideas for project brainstorming.
- Explicitly Allowed Assignments: AI may be used in completing assignments only when explicitly stated in the assignment instructions. These will be designed to specifically leverage AI capabilities in a way that enhances the learning objectives of the task.

Prohibited Use of AI:

- General Assignments and Examinations: The use of generative AI is strictly prohibited in the completion of regular assignments and during examinations. Assignments are crafted to assess individual understanding and the ability to apply marketing concepts independently.
- Discussion Contributions: Participation in course discussions, whether online or in-person, must be free of AI assistance. The value of these discussions lies in personal insights, original thought, and interaction among peers, which AI usage could undermine.

Rationale:

- The educational value of assignments and discussions in this course stems from personal intellectual engagement and the development of individual analytical skills. AI, while beneficial in certain contexts, can shortcut these learning processes and reduce the depth of personal understanding and critical thinking.

Enforcement:

- Students are expected to adhere to this policy as part of their commitment to academic integrity. Violations of the AI usage policy will be subject to review under the standard academic misconduct procedures and could result in disciplinary action.

Support and Clarifications:

- Students are encouraged to seek clarification from the instructor regarding the use of AI tools in specific instances. The instructor is available to provide guidance on how AI can be appropriately integrated into learning activities without compromising educational outcomes.